quarantine lifted—for both are sources of tension. Meanwhile discussion can continue on other aspects of the problem." The letter was handed to Dobrynin the same day along with a warning that "this matter was reaching a turning point and that if progress cannot be made, we may soon find ourselves back in a position of increasing tension."[13]

Once again it was Kennedy, not Khrushchev, who was demanding and threatening. The two leaders had long switched roles. If earlier the agenda and pace of events had been set mainly by Khrushchev, even when he was in retreat, now it was Kennedy who was in charge and running the show. Kennedy and his advisers were in a winner-take-all mood, no longer expecting Khrushchev to start a nuclear war over Cuba and pushing for new concessions. If on October 20 Kennedy had told his advisers that they would have to learn to live with Soviet bombers in Cuba, there was now a conviction that such tolerance would be unnecessary.

With pressure from Kennedy growing and Khrushchev's readiness to use nuclear weapons diminishing by the day, Khrushchev had to choose between Castro and his youthful dream of world revolution on the one hand and the interests of his country, which did not want war with the United States, on the other. When he issued his letter of October 28 accepting Kennedy's deal, he thought that he could reconcile the two visions. But now Khrushchev the revolutionary had to confront Khrushchev the national leader and choose one course or the other.

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CASTRO'S THREAT TO RESUME SHOOTING AT AMERICAN PLANES over Cuba, first made in his letter of November 15 to U Thant, had brought the situation back to the brink of war. Almost immediately after learning of the letter, Adlai Stevenson protested to Vasilii Kuznetsov, the top Soviet diplomat at the UN, warning him that "this would be a very serious matter with predictable consequences." He told his Soviet counterpart that "aerial surveillance was the only means we had to assure ourselves in light of the Soviet failure [to] produce verification in Cuba." Kuznetsov did his best to